Why this app exists

One CAT owner. Deliberate source selection. Independent RX and TX.

My IC-9700 is already **TRX2 in RUMlogNG**. I wanted RUMlogNG to remain the sole application connected to its CAT/USB port while MacDoppler supplied satellite frequencies upstream.

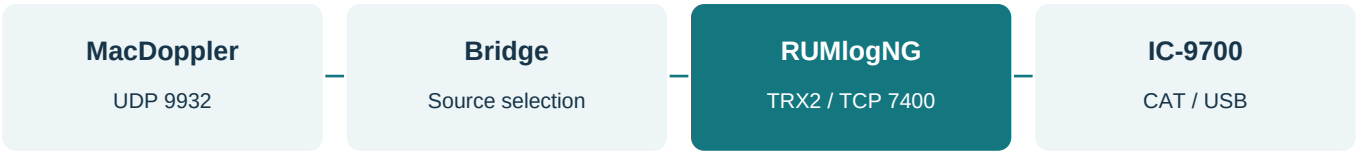
QO-100 is the home operating environment

Named pairs cover digital operation, different SSB meeting frequencies and CW. One click applies a pair once; afterward, manual radio tuning remains possible. Pair editing belongs in Settings, keeping Operations compact.

Check a LEO without surrendering the home setup

MacDoppler can track and broadcast in the background while I operate on QO-100. Its packets are displayed but blocked until I select MacDoppler. Returning to a QO-100 row revokes that authority and applies the selected pair once.

The signal path



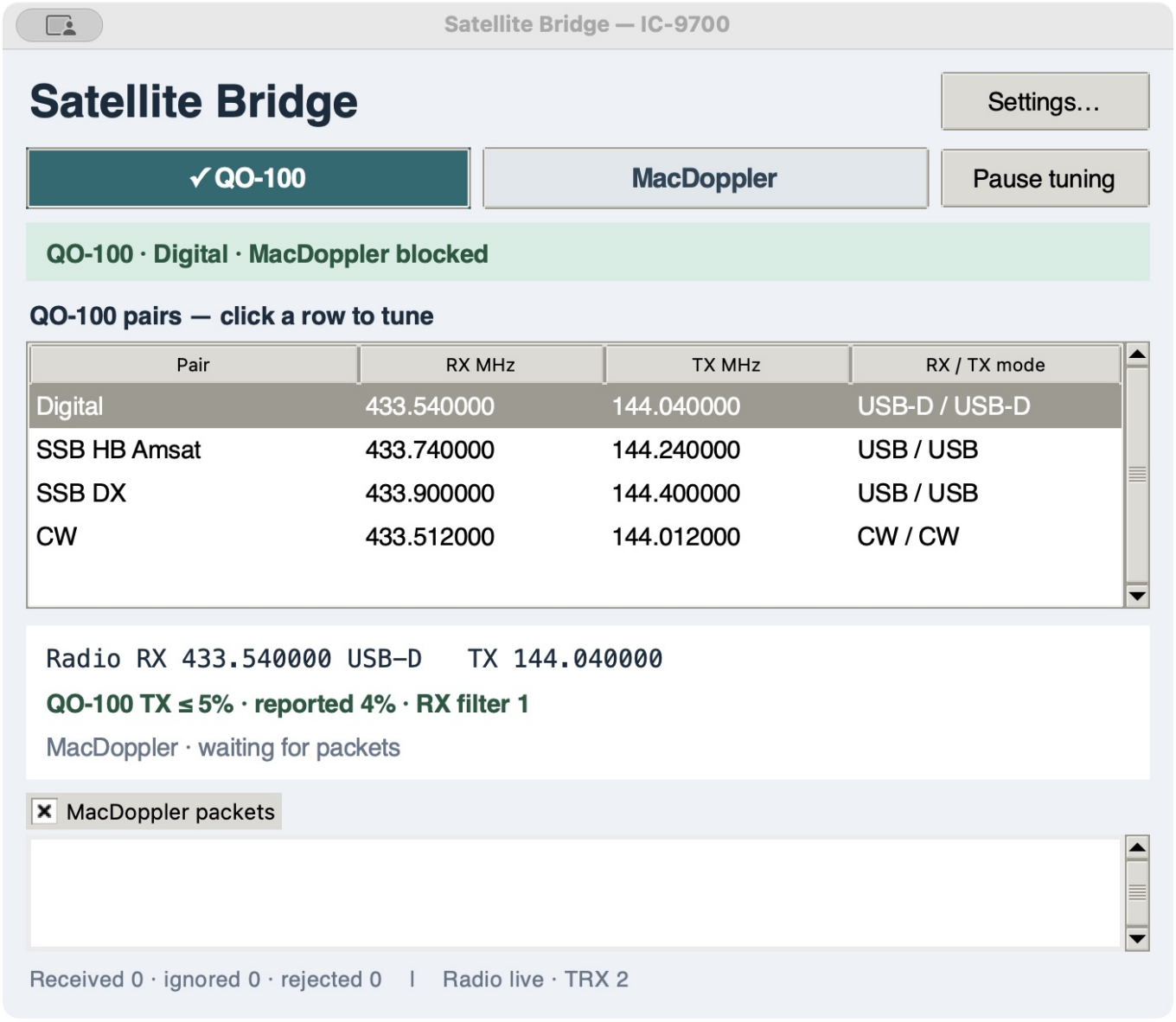
The bridge also uses RUMlogNG's panel through macOS Accessibility for SAT, RF power, the RX filter and feedback. It never opens the radio's serial device.

Independent frequencies and converter protection

Downlink controls RX; uplink controls TX. Neither is calculated from the other. The QO-100 TX output feeds a converter, so this mode requires a maximum RF power setting of **5%**. The guard is software with feedback latency, not a hardware RF limiter.

Operations at a glance

An actual screenshot of version 1.0.4 on the original station.



QO-100 Digital is selected, all four saved pairs remain available, and the readback shows RX 433.540000 MHz / TX 144.040000 MHz with power at 4%. The source button and banner identify QO-100 authority; MacDoppler is blocked.

The packet feed is open. No MacDoppler packets were arriving at capture time, so the screenshot is not evidence of an active UDP test. Separate live tests are summarized later in this guide.

Install and connect

Intel app with bundled Python/Tk; no Terminal needed for normal operation.

Download the Intel ZIP from the GitHub release, extract it, and copy **Satellite Bridge.app** into an Applications folder. Add it to the Dock if desired.

First launch on a different station
The example pairs are the original station's dial/transverter IF values. Keep RUMlogNG closed while first editing them in Settings. Retain exactly one pair named **Digital**. Every subsequent new launch applies Digital automatically once access and power verification are ready.

Connection	Setting
MacDoppler to bridge	UDP 127.0.0.1:9932
Bridge to RUMlogNG TRX2	TCP 127.0.0.1:7400
RUMlogNG to IC-9700	Existing CAT/USB connection; RUMlogNG owns it

RUMlogNG: configure the IC-9700 as TRX2, enable its DXLab Commander server on TCP 7400, and make the ICOM IC-9700 control window available.

MacDoppler: select the UDP Broadcast radio driver, set address 127.0.0.1 and port 9932, and enable Radio output. Do not add another direct CAT connection to this radio.

macOS: enable Satellite Bridge under System Settings > Privacy & Security > Accessibility. This release is ad-hoc signed, not Developer ID signed or notarized; a downloaded copy can be blocked. See Apple's guidance linked on the last page.

Supplied dial-frequency examples

Pair	RX MHz	TX MHz	Both modes
Digital	433.540000	144.040000	USB-D
SSB HB Amsat	433.740000	144.240000	USB
SSB DX	433.900000	144.400000	USB
CW	433.512000	144.012000	CW

These are IC-9700 IF/dial values, not 10 GHz / 2.4 GHz frequencies. No transverter offset is inferred.

Daily operation

QO-100 writes once. MacDoppler forwards its continuing Doppler corrections.

QO-100

Click a saved row. The bridge selects QO-100 authority, cancels pending MacDoppler work, and sends one batch of RX/TX frequencies and modes. It then checks feedback without a frequency retry. Selecting the row again is an explicit request to reapply it.

Manual tuning is left alone and appears in RUMlogNG readback. USB/USB-D select **RX filter 1**; CW/CW-R select **RX filter 2**. The TX filter is not changed.

MacDoppler

Click MacDoppler to forward its live downlink and uplink independently. Only changed fields are sent during ongoing corrections. A cached report is accepted for up to eight seconds; otherwise the app waits. Invalid or same-band On Exit reports are rejected.

Frequency-only corrections may continue during operator-keyed TX. Source/mode changes wait for PTT release. The app has no PTT-on or PTT-off operation. CTCSS fields are not forwarded in 1.0.4.

Return, pause and observe

Select any QO-100 row to block MacDoppler again and apply that pair once. Pause tuning stops frequency/mode writes while feedback and packet display continue. Use the packet checkbox to show actual incoming messages with forwarded/blocked/rejected labels.

Power is separate from tuning

The 5% QO-100 ceiling is verified before tuning, checked afterward and monitored while QO-100 remains selected, including while paused. The tested radio commonly reports 4% after a 5% request.

Temporary power-read failures hold output and retry verification. A pending selection that has sent no tuning commands can then be sent once. A batch already sent is never replayed by power recovery. An explicit Pause or source change takes precedence.

Readback is not command history

The main line displays values read from RUMlogNG's panel, normally each second. Missing data says waiting; old data is marked stale. Missing TX modes are not invented. A QO-100 selection is checked for stable feedback, but a mismatch never triggers automatic retuning.

Evidence and limitations

A station-tested preview, with current behavior described explicitly.

Known issue in 1.0.4: Toggle
Feedback reads automatically enable RUMlogNG's Toggle control. Turning it off manually is not preserved. Removing this override is planned. QO-100 frequency/mode writes are one-shot, but the overall feedback path is not completely free of control actions.

Test environment	Observed configuration
Computer	Intel Mac; macOS 15.7.3
Applications	RUMlogNG 6.5.1; MacDoppler 2.48
Radio connection	IC-9700 as RUMlogNG TRX2; USB at 19200 baud
Bundled runtime	Python 3.12.14; Tcl/Tk 9.0.4

What was checked

50 local tests use simulated endpoints/control models. Earlier live tests used actual MacDoppler UDP packets and operator confirmation of RX-only and TX-only changes at the IC-9700. These are separate from the local test suite.

An observation-only 1.0.4 startup check recorded exactly one RX setter, one TX setter and one mode setter per side. Digital readback remained 433.540000 / 144.040000 MHz, RX USB-D, RX filter 1, power 4%. TX USB-D was requested; the panel did not independently expose TX mode.

Why stable confirmation matters

An Amsat selection briefly showed requested TX 144.240000 MHz, then RUMlogNG reported the previous 144.198770 MHz. No later bridge frequency setter appeared, and MacDoppler packets were blocked. A separate diagnostic TX setter restored 144.240000. The exact cause was not established.

The app now reports unconfirmed feedback without automatically resending frequencies. Readback is still RUMlogNG's report, not an independent CAT connection or RF measurement.

Permissions and saved data

Ad-hoc-signed executable updates may require removing and re-adding the app's Accessibility entry. Settings and rotating logs live outside the bundle in ~/Library/Application Support/Satellite Bridge/. App updates preserve saved pairs.

Planned next steps

The following requirements are not implemented in the 1.0.4 download.

A third operating mode: Terrestrial

Add named repeater and simplex profiles with the same Settings editor / one-click Operations model as QO-100. Repeater entries hold RX (repeater output), TX (repeater input), duplex direction/offset including DUP-, mode, and a TX CTCSS opening tone or none.

Simplex entries use equal RX/TX frequencies and no duplex offset, with voice/data settings. One requested example is a **144.800 MHz packet-radio channel**. Selecting Terrestrial should disable SAT, block MacDoppler and apply the profile once, then allow manual tuning.

Planned power defaults

Mode	Planned behavior
QO-100	Maximum 5%; verify before tuning and monitor
MacDoppler	Default 80%, applied once on mode entry
Terrestrial	Default 80%, applied once on mode entry

Outside QO-100, subsequent manual power adjustment remains possible. Incoming Doppler reports must not repeatedly reset power. Version 1.0.4 does not raise power on entry to MacDoppler. Respecting the operator's Toggle setting is also pending.

Project, licensing and references

github.com/matpet/satellite-bridge
Source, setup guide, design rationale, validation summary, issues and releases.

Original bridge code and documentation: MIT, copyright 2026 Matthias Peter. Bundled Python, Tcl, Tk and the PyInstaller bootloader retain their own licenses; complete notices accompany the release.

RUMlogNG IC-9700 control documentation
Recommends 115200 baud for USB. Both ends must be configured together; the bridge does not change baud rates.

Apple: Safely open apps on your Mac
Explains macOS handling of downloaded, unidentified or unnotarized apps.

RUMlogNG, MacDoppler and Icom products are external interoperability targets and are not included in this release.